What do our users really need from this app?

Saw our ad: 60

Tried the app: 12

N1
N2
N3
N4
N5
N6



AI Persona

Sarah, 24
Marketing assistant
Earns $3,500 a month
Loves yoga
Syncs her bank accounts.

What problem are we solving?

Root problem: few people try the team's budgeting app.

ROOT PROBLEM

Few people try the app

- A student team is building a budgeting app.
- **60** students saw the ad. Only **12** tried the app.
- The ad said "Take control of your money!" and spoke to no real need.

THE TEAM'S IDEA

Let AI create personas

- AI could describe the customers and write better ads.
- But the profiles must come from real evidence.

WHAT WENT WRONG

An invented customer

- ChatGPT created "Sarah, 24, marketing assistant, earns $3,500, loves yoga, syncs her bank accounts."
- None of it came from the six interviews.
- The ad promised **bank syncing**, which the app does not have.

Today's goal and a three-step method

Use AI to build customer profiles from evidence, not from imagination.

STEP 1

Give the AI the evidence

- Paste the interview notes and product facts.
- Tell the AI to "use only" them.

STEP 2

Require a note for every detail

- Each need and barrier cites a note ID.
- Check each citation yourself.

STEP 3

Check every message

- Use only available features.
- Label untested claims "Hypothesis."

Product facts

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_2_4_interview_notes.csv

AVAILABLE

What the app can do

- Manual expense entry
- A weekly spending view
- Bill reminders

NOT AVAILABLE

What the app cannot do (yet)

- Bank account linking
- Price: not set yet

Six interview notes

This is the evidence. Every profile detail must point to one of these notes.

Note	What the person said
N1	My work shifts change every week, so my pay changes too. I want to know how much I can spend before Friday.
N2	I get paid on different days each month. I never know if I can afford a weekend trip.
N3	I forget bill dates even when I have the money. A reminder a few days early would help.
N4	I paid a late fee twice last semester because I missed my phone bill.
N5	I already use a spreadsheet. I would switch only if tracking takes less time.
N6	I do not want a new app to connect to my bank account.

Evidence, need, and barrier

Before you ask an AI to describe customers, know what these words mean.

WORD 1

Evidence

What real people said or did.

Here: the six interview notes, N1 to N6.

WORD 2

Need

The progress a person wants to make.

```
N1: know how much I can spend before Friday
```

WORD 3

Barrier

What stops a person from trying a product.

```
N6: no bank connection
```

Customer profile and hypothesis

Each example uses the budgeting app.

WORD 4

Customer profile

A short summary of one group with the same need, supported by **at least two notes**.

```
Pay changes, wants safe weekly spending (N1, N2)
```

WORD 5

Hypothesis

A claim the team believes but has not tested yet.

Example: "A weekly spending view will help people with changing pay." Label it as a hypothesis, not a fact.

"Sounds real" and "comes from evidence" are different

Check each detail of the AI persona against the notes.

AI persona detail	Supporting note	Result
Sarah, 24	None	Invented
Marketing assistant	None	Invented
Earns $3,500 a month	None	Invented
Loves yoga	None	Invented
Syncs her bank accounts	**N6 says the opposite; the app has no bank linking**	**Wrong**

EVIDENCE COUNT

0 of 5 details

```
0 of 5 details come from the interviews
```

- One detail goes against the evidence.

WHY

Typical, not real

- Without notes, the AI filled the profile with typical marketing details.
- The bank-syncing ad promised a feature the app does not have.

How the three-step method fixes the profile

The instructor runs the prompts below and compares the answers.

STEP 1 FIXES

The evidence problem

- The AI can only use what people actually said.

STEP 2 FIXES

The trust problem

- Every need and barrier has a note ID you can check in seconds.
- A detail with no note becomes a question for the next interview.

STEP 3 FIXES

The false-promise problem

- Each message names the feature it uses.
- Unavailable features cannot appear.

Poor prompt 1

Same notes and product facts. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Create two customer personas for our budgeting app and write an ad for each one.

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

Two persona cards with names, ages, jobs, incomes, and hobbies, and ads such as "Sync all your accounts and save $200 a month!"

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- It gives no interview notes, so the AI invents typical customers.
- It gives no product facts, so the ads can promise features the app does not have.
- The details sound real but cannot be checked, so the team cannot trust them.

Poor prompt 2

Copy this prompt exactly.

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Here are our interview notes:
N1: My work shifts change every week, so my pay changes too. I want to know how much I can spend before Friday.
N2: I get paid on different days each month. I never know if I can afford a weekend trip.
N3: I forget bill dates even when I have the money. A reminder a few days early would help.
N4: I paid a late fee twice last semester because I missed my phone bill.
N5: I already use a spreadsheet. I would switch only if tracking takes less time.
N6: I do not want a new app to connect to my bank account.

Create two exciting personas with a name, age, job, and income,
and write ads that make them excited to buy.

Message AI...

Why it is weak: poor prompt 2

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

Personas that use the notes but add an age, a job, and an income for each person, and ads that promise to "save you money every month."

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- It asks for a name, age, job, and income, but the notes do not contain any of them, so the AI must invent them.
- "Make them excited to buy" pushes the AI toward big promises instead of real needs.
- It gives no product facts, so nothing stops the ads from promising unavailable features.

Improved prompt 1

Steps 1 and 2. Copy this prompt exactly.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

We are building a budgeting app. Use only the interview notes and product facts below.

Product facts:
- Available: manual expense entry, a weekly spending view, bill reminders.
- Not available: bank account linking. Price: not set.

Interview notes:
N1: My work shifts change every week, so my pay changes too. I want to know how much I can spend before Friday.
N2: I get paid on different days each month. I never know if I can afford a weekend trip.
N3: I forget bill dates even when I have the money. A reminder a few days early would help.
N4: I paid a late fee twice last semester because I missed my phone bill.
N5: I already use a spreadsheet. I would switch only if tracking takes less time.
N6: I do not want a new app to connect to my bank account.

Group the notes by similar need. Make two customer profiles.
Each profile needs at least two notes with the same need.
For each profile, give: the need, the supporting note IDs, one barrier with its note ID,
the available feature that fits the need, and one question for the next interview.
Every detail must cite a note ID. Do not add age, job, income, or hobbies.
Do not write ads yet.

Message AI...

Why it works: improved prompt 1

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- It gives the AI the six notes and the product facts, which fixes the missing evidence in Poor Prompt 1.
- "Every detail must cite a note ID" makes each detail easy to check.
- "At least two notes with the same need" stops the AI from building a profile on one comment.
- "Do not add age, job, income, or hobbies" removes the invented details from Poor Prompt 2.
- "Do not write ads yet" keeps understanding the customer and selling to the customer as separate steps.

Improved prompt 2

Step 3, sent in the same chat after Improved Prompt 1. Copy this prompt exactly.

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

I checked your profiles against the notes.
Profile A (pay changes, wants safe weekly spending): N1, N2.
Profile B (forgets bills, wants early reminders): N3, N4.
Barriers: N5 (tracking must be fast), N6 (no bank connection).

Write one short message for each profile, under 30 words.
Use only available features. Do not promise savings or a price.
After each message, list the note IDs and the feature it uses.
Label any claim we have not tested as "Hypothesis."

Message AI...

Why it works: improved prompt 2

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- It gives the AI the checked profiles, so the messages are built on evidence.
- It limits the messages to available features, which prevents the bank-syncing promise.
- Listing note IDs and features after each message makes the check easy.
- "Hypothesis" labels keep untested claims honest, such as "the weekly view will save you time."

Exercise 1: Build profiles from evidence

Guided practice. Follow the five steps in order.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Steps

1. Open ChatGPT and start a **new chat**. Paste and send **Poor Prompt 1**. Count the details in each persona and how many come from the notes.
2. Start another **new chat**. Paste and send **Improved Prompt 1**.
3. Check every note ID: open the note and confirm it says what the AI claims. Compare with the answer key.
4. In the same chat, paste and send **Improved Prompt 2**. Check that no message mentions bank syncing, savings, or a price.
5. For the Results section of your report, write the evidence count (for example, "0 of 5 details from notes") and the two profiles with note IDs.

Answer key: two profiles

Use this table to check the AI. N5 and N6 can apply to both profiles if the note ID is cited.

Profile	Need	Notes	Barrier	Feature that fits
A	Pay changes; wants to know safe spending for the week	N1, N2	Tracking must take less time than a spreadsheet (N5)	Weekly spending view
B	Forgets bill dates; wants a reminder before the due date	N3, N4	Does not want to connect a bank account (N6)	Bill reminders, with manual entry and no bank linking

Exercise 2: Place new interview notes

The team runs two more interviews. Where does each new note belong?

HOW IT WORKS

Fit, or wait for more evidence

- Compare the new note with each profile's notes.
- A profile needs at least **two** notes with the same need.
- If no feature meets the need, write "Not available."
- Never promise a feature the app does not have.

TEMPLATE - REPLACE EACH [PART], THEN SEND

AI Chat

You

Continue with the same notes, product facts, and profiles.
Here is a new interview note: [note ID and text].
Does it fit Profile A, Profile B, or neither? Cite the note IDs you compare it with.
Remember: a profile needs at least two notes with the same need.
Which available feature, if any, meets this need? If none, write "Not available."
Do not promise a feature the app does not have.

Message AI...

Part A: Worked example (run it)

In the chat from Exercise 1, copy and send this completed prompt.

PART A - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Continue with the same notes, product facts, and profiles.
Here is a new interview note: N7: "I share rent and groceries with two
roommates. I want an easy way to split costs with them."
Does it fit Profile A, Profile B, or neither? Cite the note IDs you compare it with.
Remember: a profile needs at least two notes with the same need.
Which available feature, if any, meets this need? If none, write "Not available."
Do not promise a feature the app does not have.

Message AI...

CHECK THE ANSWER

N7: splitting costs

- Fits **neither** profile: the need does not match N1-N2 or N3-N4.
- Only one note, so it cannot be a new profile yet.
- Splitting costs is **Not available**. Ask about it in the next interviews.

Part B: Your turn (write it)

N8: "I tutor and work at a cafe, so my pay comes on different days. On Friday I decide if I can go out."

YOUR TASK

Fill in the template yourself

- Include the note ID and text.
- Include the rule about two notes.
- Send it in the same chat.

CHECK THE ANSWER

N8 fits Profile A

- Like N1 and N2, pay comes on different days, and the person wants to know weekly spending.
- Profile A now has three notes: **N1, N2, N8**.
- Feature that fits: **weekly spending view**.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W8_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- **Introduction:** Explain the team's root problem (60 students saw the ad, but only 12 tried the app), its idea to let AI create personas, and why the first AI persona was not useful.
- **Method:** Copy Poor Prompt 1, Improved Prompts 1 and 2, the Part A prompt, and the Part B prompt you wrote.
- **Results:** Include the evidence count for Poor Prompt 1, the two profiles with their note IDs, the two messages with their features, and your answers for N7 and N8.
- **Conclusion:** Recommend which profile the next ad should target and why, in one or two sentences. Name one note that supports it and one hypothesis the team still needs to test.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- You can explain in one sentence why the AI persona "Sarah, 24" was not useful to the team, and your Part B prompt places N8 in Profile A with note IDs cited.